

Disaster Recovery Plan for a Medium-Sized Business Network

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The disaster recovery plan I made focuses on a medium-sized business network for an IT service company called Reset Solutions. The company has about 200 employees across the main

headquarters and a smaller satellite office. This plan aims to build network reliability and minimize the downtime of the network if there is a failure.

Some of the key components in the network are the data center in the headquarters, which is the primary location that has all of the critical servers and applications, including email, CRM, and any other database systems. The satellite office is connected using a high-speed VPN link. The core switches and routers manage all of the internal and external network communication. The firewall provides security to the network. There are employee devices like workstations and laptops. There are also cloud services for backup storage and application hosting.

One of the main areas that are vulnerable to failures or disasters is the data center. The data center is susceptible to things like hardware failures, power outages, and natural disasters. The communication links are vulnerable to ISP outages or any physical damage to cables. Servers can experience things like hardware issues or software malfunctions, which would cause interruptions. Cloud services are dependent on the cloud provider's uptime so if there is downtime at the cloud provider it also causes downtime at the business.

The disaster recovery strategies id use include data backups, redundancy, failover systems, and emergency response procedures. Regular backups need to take place on both local devices and on a cloud service. They would be scheduled daily for incremental backups and weekly for full system backups. This helps data stay retrievable if there is a failure or ransomware attack. Redundancy is important. Having redundant power, network paths, and critical hardware can save a company a lot of trouble. Using things like uninterruptible power supplies to ensure critical operations are able to be shut down safely or be kept on long enough for a standby generator to start in the event of a power outage is important. Uninterruptible power supplies with surge protection are also important for protecting equipment from things

like lightning strikes or power fluctuations. Having redundancy reduces the number of single points of failure within a network.

Another very important part is having good emergency response procedures. The business needs to have very clear response protocols if a failure takes place. Staff should be trained and have established escalation paths so that they know what to do when issues come up.

There are some challenges to having a disaster recovery plan, but there are plenty of ways to avoid them. One big challenge would be cost. Hardware costs and software costs can be high. A good way to avoid a ton of upfront costs is to implement things in increments. Employee compliance can also be an issue. Employees may forget their training. Having audits and training drills is a good way to avoid that. Relying on cloud providers is another thing that can be costly. Using services that allow for on-demand scaling, like AWS, is a good way to avoid too much upfront cost. It's also very important to make sure your cloud provider is known for their reliability.

This disaster recovery plan for Reset Solutions will help keep their network up and reliable. It will also help them come back quickly if there ever is a failure. Using data backups, redundancy, failover systems, and emergency response procedures will save them a lot of money and a lot of trouble if something happens. This plan balances costs well. It also will be able to support any growth the business has in the short term or long term.

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